

Lititz BMX: Fireside BMX Chat Podcast Plan

Host: Kyle A. Huffman
Guest: Greg Hill

Recording Date: _____

Introduction

Thank you for considering being a guest on my podcast. This podcast grew from a lack of an outlet for a retired Instructional Designer, Veteran, and BMX hack. Really, the perfect storm as you will most likely learn soon.

So, here is the lead-up timeline:

- Aug 2024: I purchased a Radical Rick trophy (plaque) on eBay, for my RR collection, and asked the seller who earned it. I was told "I purchased Harry Leary's storage unit last year". I looked around and on faith bought a few more items before buying my first "lot" from the seller.

I shared that purchases were made, with the seller by name, in two facebook groups and was met with crickets (August 24th). Noone cared. I was told it was a "fool's investment" and laughed at or ignored. I have purchased four lots now and plan on purchasing more as the opportunity arises; the seller and I have developed a friendship. I don't know what he has in inventory, I am going mostly on blind faith when available.

- Suddenly, starting September 7th, everyone cared but I was asked not to participate in other groups and respectfully withdrew.
- So, I started The Unofficial Harry Leary Fireside Chat Group on Facebook and began developing content to support the page, with goals of:
1) enhancing my understanding of my own collection, 2) giving myself a "retired professional" outlet (creativity not financial), and 3) developing and nurturing a living Harry Leary Body of Knowledge that includes open discussions, perhaps a place to work through grief of his passing and many issues created during his life, and public validation and verification of Harry Leary items.

This podcast is the next step in the evolution of this program.

Notes:

Conversation Outline

Setting the stage:

This podcast draws inspiration from many hours as a kid spent listening to cassettes of old radio programs - where you had to use a bit of imagination but the stories were amazing. Throw in content awareness from Howard Stern and you have the show's core foundation. It pairs that with a stage that draws inspiration from our Facebook group's fireside chat theme. This podcast's theme will be based on a fireside chat held at my house in my garage, with the background of a propane heater that constantly goes out.

Think of this as a limited movie experience disguised as an interview, just without video.

Introduction: "Hello"

****I don't believe listeners should be subjected to a long over produced intro that does nothing to actually enhance the content.****

This podcast will provide a brief introduction consisting of: 1) a garage door opening, 2) background audio of a propane heater (throughout), 3) brief exchanged pleasantries, and 4) conversation about my garage rehab and recommendation for epoxy flooring. During the conversation, Greg notices my Dirtwerx bike and that leads to our conversation.

Think & Imagine: Kyle rolls up the garage door (audio) and says "Hi Greg, thank you for coming down to discuss epoxy options for my garage."

Greg: "No problem, how can I help?"

Kyle: "We are finally redoing our garage...."

"I was thinking I wanted to go with epoxy flooring and I want to get your opinion on it."

Greg: "Epoxy is a good idea because xxxxxxxx and we guarantee our work...."...

- Recognition of the DIRTWERX BMX bike in my garage:

Greg: "I see you have an old BMX bike there"

Kyle: "Yeah, I am working on cleaning it up. In fact, you used to race BMX in the 70's and 80's right?"

Greg: "You can say that"

Kyle: "You may know the previous owner. His name was Harry Leary."

Greg: "...."

- Greg reflects and shares based on a facilitated discussion:

- Parting ways, thanks, and "let me run the numbers and get you a quote..."

Potential Questions (Base)

Harry Related:

- I remember listening to a podcast where Harry Leary talked about developing his signature jump "The Leary" because of you. My understanding is that he kept trying to buzz your helmet with his rear tire as you sat on jumps at the track, and that he had to keep getting further and further away from you so you didn't suspect anything was coming.
 - How many times did he tag you?
 - What was running through your head knowing this was coming and that he just wouldn't stop?
 - Then, there was officially "The Leary" - how much did he boast about that and how proud were you to have been a part of it?
- Wikipedia has Harry Leary listed as being a GHP rider 2007 - 2024 (Amatuer) and 2007 - 2015 (Professional).
 - Did Harry really ride with GHP until the end?
 - How does that come into play with Fall Risk Racing?
- Story of Harry Leary's GHP mountain bike - why a GHP frame?
- How does your opinion of Harry vary so much from so many in the inner circle of BMX, even those of his close friends?
- What do you want people to know about Harry, your truth of him?
- One word: Describe Harry Leary as a friend
- One word: Describe Harry Leary as a BMX legend
- If you could say one last thing to Harry, what would it be?

Non-Harry Related:

- I hear you have a guitar but don't know how to play it. What's the first song you want to learn to play?
- I once heard you say "There is no clock on the truth", where did you get that?
- Have you ever gotten a "boxer's fracture" - if so, how?
- What BMX injury have you had, that hurts now that you are older more than any other?
- It seems like our Dads were very similar, with regards to support and discipline, the story of your Dad taking you to your bully's house reminded me of my Dad telling me that I would have to answer to him if he ever saw me playing bunch ball during my first soccer game. As a Dad, how hard was it to squash the less than desirable traits we inherited? As a new Dad, I find myself "slipping" sometimes with things I told myself I would never do, what's your advice to deal with that anxiety?
- How cool is it being a Grandparent?
- Your parents were partners in Western Sports Arama with Stephen Rink right? How was your relationship with him and Mark?
 - Why did you not ride for Powerlite?
- What was it like for you as the fire was burning out to "compete" in BMX? Can you explain your emotions through that process?
- You seem to be on a path of quote unquote setting the record straight on some things, how bad has the backlash been?
- On a scale of one to ten, how happy are you that you shifted from BMX to epoxy flooring?
 - What is one piece of advice you would give to someone who may want to switch industries or "start over" - even if you are only making \$10/hour?

Connecting and Recording

We will connect by phone. Once connected, I will place the call on speaker and begin the recording on my iPhone. This is done to allow for a clear/clean local recording and redundancy with other external recording devices.

The great thing about being an audio focused podcast is that we have the liberty of editing pretty easy. I can easily:

- Clear-up most "Um's" "Ah's" "Uh's" etc. Even a cough. I just ask that you think to leave me a buffer to clean things up - just a brief moment if you can.
- If you make an error, or misspeak, don't like how something came out, or your wife opens the door and asks for you to pick up milk... It is ok, we can pause and you can reframe your thoughts and I will edit accordingly.

Please make sure you are in as quiet of a room as possible - life happens but driving down the 5 with the top down does not make for a good recording. If you have a headset, please use it. I'll probably have my daughter, so - professional, I know.

The power of editing is a wonderful thing.

A Little About Kyle

Kyle is a late 70's baby and has all of the likes and quirks of one who grew up in The SF East Bay during that time frame. Like most of his generation, he's kind of a hodgepodge of eclectic stirrings. But, there are those who love him regardless.

So... Here are:

Five "Interesting" Facts

- 1) He has hired over 1000 people and even developed an employment path for "unqualified" candidates that had a good personality, as a Silicon Valley tech company direct hiring manager during high growth pre and post IPO periods. This team went on to earn SC Magazine Awards 3 of his 4 years for "Industry Best Customer Service".
- 2) Kyle inherited a pet piranha.
- 3) His collection of 13 BMX bikes and fun memorabilia has him wanting to open a museum eventually - *"I'm a "retired" Instructional Designer and one of my Master Degrees is in Education with a focus on Online Teaching & Learning so it is the perfect retirement job."*
- 4) He is the son of a former Hells Angel who went to prison when Kyle was two years old.
- 5) He founded the Veterans Employee Resource Group (VERG) for a major financial institution and within 3 years the group earned a Secretary of Defense Employer Support Freedom Award.
- 6) He had his first daughter at the age of 44. She is the blessing of his life and he is grateful that he is able to be a Stay-at-Home Dad with her. Their current thing is Ms. Rachel.

You said five - Oh, you caught that...

He is a 100% VA Disabled Veteran who deployed twice onboard the USS Oldendorf (DD-972), earned the designator of Master Training Specialist (MTS) while stationed at the Naval Security Group Activity (NSGA)/Cryptologic Readiness Group (CRG), and served as a Senior Consultant: Cryptologic Intelligence Collection Operations at the Space and Naval Warfare Command (SPAWAR) - Under NSA tasking & is a "451" graduate (Intermediate Signal Analyst).

Ok, so... LinkedIn stuff over. I've done a lot but I have my demons. I have over 6 years of sobriety from alcohol. Shortly after quitting drinking, I discovered I was Bi-Polar 1 - the fight of my life began. It's a long story that nearly cost me everything, hell - I nearly threw it all away. Nearly...

My Story finds hope

Conclusion

Thank you. I look forward to hearing back from you.